CHINA SOLAR: POLY

3Q26 wrap: stronger shipment but ASP remained weak; price law enforcement still under debate

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3Q26 result wrap: Daqo ADR missed but Daqo A/Tongwei beat on stronger shipment: The two Poly companies under our coverage (i.e. Daqo A/ADR, Tongwei) announced 3Q26 earnings.

- Daqo ADR's results missed expectation: The company reported revenue of US$194mn and a net loss of US$53mn in 3Q26, below our estimates of US$62mn/US$32mn loss. While higher-than-expected shipments (47k tons in 3Q26 2X of 15k tons in prior GSe) boosted the topline, ASP remained weak (+2% qoq). As the company continued operating at a loss per unit, this increase in volume actually served to widen the net loss. Mgmt. noted this shipment surge was primarily due to the fulfillment of old orders signed prior to recent price hikes and transaction activity has been muted since price hike in early-Aug.
- Conversely, A-share names Daqo A and Tongwei both outperformed expectations. This beat was mainly driven by lower unit costs and higher inventory impairment reversal per China accounting rule as a result from stronger shipment. If we strip out these impairment reversals to look at core operational performance, we estimate GPM to drop to -42% for Daqo A (from -16%) and -2% for Tongwei (from +3%), though these figures still remain better than our previous estimates of -70% and -4%, respectively. In terms of shipment, Daqo reported 2X qoq increase to 47kton in 3Q vs. 15kton in prior GSe, and we estimate Tongwei recorded c.80kton shipment in 3Q vs. 28kton in prior GSe.

Looking ahead, we remain cautious on price recovery as we stay skeptical on the success of joint price hikes. Outlook guided by Daqo suggests inventory management has over taken price hike, and industry wise price law enforcement remain under debate with no consensus reached yet regarding joint production cut. Therefore, we remain cautious on the success of the joint price hikes particularly on the back of deteriorating industry fundamentals since August.

Consequently, we expect shipment volume for Poly players to decline by ~30% qoq with ASP staying largely flat qoq in 4Q26. Reflecting 3Q26 result (impairment reversal and higher shipment), we reduce our net loss estimate by an avg. 16% for Daqo A/ADR and Tongwei in 2026E, and keep 2027E-30E largely unchanged. Accordingly, our target prices for Daqo ADR/A, Tongwei are revised up to

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US$10.1/Rmb7.8/Rmb4.4 from US$10/Rmb7.6/Rmb4.2. Reiterate Sell.

Below we summarize key takeaways from Daqo ADR's analyst briefing call:

- **Limited production cut in 4Q26 with inventory management as key focus**: Mgmt. raised its FY26 mid-point production target by 6% to 170k tons to account for a stronger 3Q. For 4Q26 specifically, production is guided at 35-45k tons, implying 46%-59% UTR in 4Q26. This suggests that production cuts are not as aggressive as some industry targets hope (35%).
- **Price law enforcement still under debate**: Mgmt. mentioned that despite a firmer tone for anti-involution recently, price law remains under debate and there is no consensus among players on joint production cuts. It seems each company is instead tailoring operational strategy to its own specific inventory and sales needs. With value chain inventory pressure remaining elevated (c.700k tons as per Mgmt.), mgmt. believe it will take several months before pricing returns to all-in cost levels (approximately Rmb43/kg).

Exhibit 1: We revise NP by +7% to +23% for our Poly coverage in 2026E and revise TP by +1% to +5%

	Ticker	RCY	PCY	12m TP (New)	TP Chg%	Closing price	TP upside%	Net income (New, in RCY)					Net income (Prior, in RCY)					Net profit change %					Rationale
								26E	27E	28E	29E	30E	26E	27E	28E	29E	30E	26E	27E	28E	29E	30E	Avg 26E-30E	26E-30E
Main value chain																								
Tongwei	600438.SS	CNY	CNY	4.40	5%	11.1	-60%	(7,965)	(7,878)	(6,946)	(6,876)	(4,662)	(9,578)	(7,862)	(6,962)	(6,894)	(4,663)	17%	0%	0%	0%	0%	3%	higher Poly shipment and impairment reversal in 3Q26
Daqo A	688303.SS	CNY	CNY	7.80	3%	16.1	-52%	(2,241)	(2,273)	(2,100)	(2,040)	(2,035)	(2,923)	(2,271)	(2,094)	(2,033)	(2,029)	23%	0%	0%	0%	0%	4%	higher Poly shipment and impairment reversal in 3Q26
Daqo US	DQ	USD	USD	10.10	1%	10.8	-6%	(242)	(289)	(267)	(263)	(266)	(261)	(289)	(267)	(262)	(266)	7%	0%	0%	0%	0%	1%	higher Poly shipment in 3Q26

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 2: Daqo ADR 3Q26 result comparison

DQ	1Q25	2Q25	3Q25	4Q25	1Q26	2Q26	3Q26	yoy %	qoq %	Prior GSe	Diff
Revenue (US$ mn)	**124**	**75**	**245**	**222**	**27**	**63**	**194**	**-21%**	**210%**	**62**	**214%**
Gross profit (US$ mn)	(82)	(81)	10	15	(139)	(83)	(61)	728%	27%	(43)	-41%
SG&A (US$ mn)	(17)	(14)	(14)	(19)	(13)	(17)	(19)	33%	9%	(15)	-23%
EBITDA (US$ mn)	(36)	(36)	59	66	(88)	(34)	(14)	124%	58%	4	n.m.
non-GAAP Net profit (US	**(53)**	**(58)**	**4**	**(7)**	**(88)**	**(81)**	**(53)**	**1535%**	**35%**	**(32)**	**-66%**
Gross profit margin (%)	**-66%**	**-108%**	**4%**	**7%**	**-522%**	**-132%**	**-31%**	**-35pp**	**101pp**	**-70%**	**38pp**
Net profit margin (%)	**-43%**	**-77%**	**2%**	**-3%**	**-331%**	**-130%**	**-27%**	**201pp**	**102pp**	**-51%**	**24pp**

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 3: Daqo A 3Q26 result comparison

Daqo A	1Q25	2Q25	3Q25	4Q25	1Q26	2Q26	3Q26	yoy %	qoq %	Prior GSe	Diff
Revenue (Rmb mn)	**907**	**563**	**1,773**	**1,596**	**189**	**434**	**1,326**	**-25%**	**205%**	**429**	**209%**
Gross profit (Rmb mn)	(267)	(234)	254	143	(228)	(236)	(215)	**184%**	9%	(298)	28%
SG&A (Rmb mn)	(89)	(72)	(61)	(81)	(62)	(84)	(83)	**36%**	-1%	(94)	12%
EBITDA (Rmb mn)	64	109	612	476	150	118	140	**-77%**	19%	46	204%
Net profit (Rmb mn)	**(558)**	**(589)**	**73**	**(56)**	**(801)**	**(794)**	**(411)**	**659%**	**48%**	**(892)**	**54%**
Gross profit margin (%)	**-29%**	**-42%**	**14%**	**9%**	**-121%**	**-54%**	**-16%**	**-31pp**	**38pp**	**-70%**	**53pp**
Net profit margin (%)	**-62%**	**-105%**	**4%**	**-4%**	**-425%**	**-183%**	**-31%**	**-35pp**	**152pp**	**-208%**	**177pp**

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

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Exhibit 4: Tongwei 3Q26 result comparison

Tongwei (Rmb mn)	1Q25	2Q25	3Q25	4Q25	1Q26	2Q26	3Q26	yoy %	qoq %	Prior GSe	Diff
Revenue	15,933	24,575	24,091	19,529	12,125	22,232	23,980	0%	8%	22,048	9%
Gross profit	(458)	488	1,741	501	(488)	(567)	796	-54%	241%	(900)	189%
Net profit	(2,593)	(2,363)	(315)	(4,283)	(2,444)	(2,675)	(1,639)	-421%	39%	(2,068)	21%
Gross profit margin (%)	-3%	2%	7%	3%	-4%	-3%	3%	-4pp	6pp	-4%	7pp
SG&A as of sales (%)	9%	6%	6%	8%	12%	6%	6%	0pp	1pp	9%	-2pp
Net profit margin (%)	-16%	-10%	-1%	-22%	-20%	-12%	-7%	-6pp	5pp	-9%	3pp

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Investment thesis, TP methodology and risks

Daqo ADR (DQ)

Investment thesis: We are Sell rated on Daqo ADR. Daqo ADR is the parent company of Xinjiang Daqo New Energy Co (688303.SS) with a 71% stake owned as of Mar 2026. They share the same topline, but differ in cost drivers. Daqo is one of China's largest poly producers that used to sit at the low end of the industry cost curve, but we think current valuation has priced in a greater degree of optimism for the new round of Poly price hike execution and valuation looks unattractive.

TP methodology: Our 12m target price for Daqo ADR of US$10.1 is based on a 0.16X 2026E P/B based on its historical regression correlation of P/B and ROE.

Key risks: 1) meaningful Tier 1 poly capacity exit and/or stronger-than-expected solar demand substantially improves the profitability outlook; 2) Daqo's cost reduction progress were to come in faster-than-expected to match the levels of its Tier 1 Poly peer GCL Tech and Tongwei, leading to higher UTR for Daqo and better margins over the longer run; 3) Faster commercialization progress on its AIDC infrastructure products.

Exhibit 5:

DQ	12m Price Target: $10.1	Price: $10.77	Downside: 6.2%

Sell

Market cap: $712.5mn
Enterprise value: $-1352800.4k
3m ADTV :$10.0mn
China
China Clean Energy & Technology
M&A Rank: 3
Leases incl. in net debt & EV?: Yes

GS Forecast

	12/25	12/26E	12/27E	12/28E
Revenue ($ mn) New	**665.4**	**423.1**	**414.5**	**362.7**
Revenue ($ mn) Old	665.4	216.3	414.5	362.7
EBITDA ($ mn)	52.7	(142.1)	(126.5)	(103.8)
EPS ($) New	**(1.73)**	**(3.66)**	**(4.37)**	**(4.04)**
EPS ($) Old	(1.73)	(3.94)	(4.37)	(4.03)
P/E (X)	NM	NM	NM	NM
P/B (X)	0.2	0.1	0.1	0.1
Dividend yield (%)	--	--	--	--
CROCI (%)	1.1	NM	NM	NM
	6/26	**9/26**	**12/26E**	**E**
EPS ($)	(1.20)	(0.78)	(0.29)	--

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Research estimates, FactSet. Price as of 30 Oct 2026 close.

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Daqo A (688303.SS)

Investment thesis: Daqo A is the 71% owned subsidiary of Daqo New Energy (DQ). They share the same topline, but differ in cost drivers. Daqo is one of China's largest poly producers that used to sit at low end of the industry cost curve, but we expect the aggressive Tier 1 capacity expansion in the poly segment to be negatively compounded by a weak demand outlook, pushing Daqo towards the high end of the industry cost curve and capping its UTR at a low level for longer. We are Sell rated on Daqo A, as we believe current valuation (P/B) has priced in too much L-T optimism in terms of both price and volume upside. We highlight that Daqo appears to have relatively less cost reduction headroom through capacity mix optimization vs. its peers, and its solid balance sheet might be relatively weakened given lower profitability inflection potential vs. some low-cost players that are likely to see easing liquidity pressure via greater profitability inflection in the anti-involution context.

TP methodology: Our 12m TP for Daqo A of Rmb7.8 is based on a 0.45X 2026E P/B based on its historical regression correlation of P/B and ROE.

Key risks: 1) meaningful Tier 1 poly capacity exit (e.g. via. higher-than-expected industry level tail capacity buyout), and/or stronger-than-expected solar demand to substantially shift the profitability outlook; 2) Daqo's cost reduction progress coming in faster than expected, which could lead to higher a UTR for Daqo and better margins over the longer run.

Exhibit 6:

688303.SS	12m Price Target: Rmb7.8	Price: Rmb16.11	Downside: 51.6%

Sell

Market cap: Rmb34.4bn / $5.2bn
Enterprise value: Rmb21.2bn / $3.2bn
3m ADTV :Rmb169.5mn/ $25.2mn
China
China Clean Energy & Technology
M&A Rank: 3
Leases incl. in net debt & EV?: No

GS Forecast

	12/25	12/26E	12/27E	12/28E
Revenue (Rmb mn) New	**4,838.5**	**2,929.5**	**2,870.0**	**2,511.2**
Revenue (Rmb mn) Old	4,838.5	1,497.6	2,870.0	2,511.2
EBITDA (Rmb mn)	1,261.3	580.9	(792.8)	(618.4)
EPS (Rmb) New	**(0.53)**	**(1.05)**	**(1.07)**	**(0.98)**
EPS (Rmb) Old	(0.53)	(1.37)	(1.06)	(0.98)
P/E (X)	NM	NM	NM	NM
P/B (X)	1.3	0.9	1.0	1.1
Dividend yield (%)	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.0
CROCI (%)	4.0	NM	NM	NM
	6/26	**9/26**	**12/26E**	**E**
EPS (Rmb)	(0.37)	(0.19)	(0.11)	--

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Research estimates, FactSet. Price as of 30 Oct 2026 close.

Tongwei (600438.SS)

Investment thesis: Tongwei is a solar world leader with an integrated business model from upstream poly to cell, and has expanded into the downstream module business since 2022. We are Sell rated on Tongwei, as we are cautious on Tongwei's high exposure to the Poly segment, which we prefer the least vs. our sector coverage due to severe oversupply (even among Top 3 Tier 1 players), and as a result, normalized ROE for Tongwei is likely to stay below its through-cycle level. We believe current valuation (on

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P/B) has overly priced in the Poly price upside with the implementation of ongoing anti-involution.

TP methodology: Our 12m target price for Tongwei of Rmb4.4 is derived from a 0.6X 26E P/B based on its historical regression correlation of P/B and ROE.

Key risks: 1) meaningful Tier 1 poly capacity exit (e.g. via. higher-than-expected industry level tail capacity buyout), and/or stronger-than-expected solar demand to substantially shift the profitability outlook; 2) better-than-expected module business development.

Exhibit 7:

600438.SS	12m Price Target: Rmb4.4	Price: Rmb11.06	Downside: 60.2%

Sell

Market cap: Rmb49.8bn / $7.5bn
Enterprise value: Rmb126.6bn / $19.0bn
3m ADTV :Rmb572.9mn/ $85.2mn
China
China Clean Energy & Technology
M&A Rank: 3
Leases incl. in net debt & EV?: No

GS Forecast

	12/25	12/26E	12/27E	12/28E
Revenue (Rmb mn) New	**84,128.3**	**81,784.0**	**93,398.7**	**102,513.2**
Revenue (Rmb mn) Old	84,128.3	78,741.6	92,828.3	101,442.8
EBITDA (Rmb mn)	7,404.5	5,237.8	2,469.4	4,381.8
EPS (Rmb) New	**(2.12)**	**(1.77)**	**(1.75)**	**(1.54)**
EPS (Rmb) Old	(2.12)	(2.13)	(1.75)	(1.55)
P/E (X)	NM	NM	NM	NM
P/B (X)	1.8	1.2	1.7	2.6
Dividend yield (%)	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.0
CROCI (%)	6.8	2.0	NM	0.4

	6/26	9/26	12/26E	E
EPS (Rmb)	(0.59)	(0.36)	(0.27)	--

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Research estimates, FactSet. Price as of 30 Oct 2026 close.

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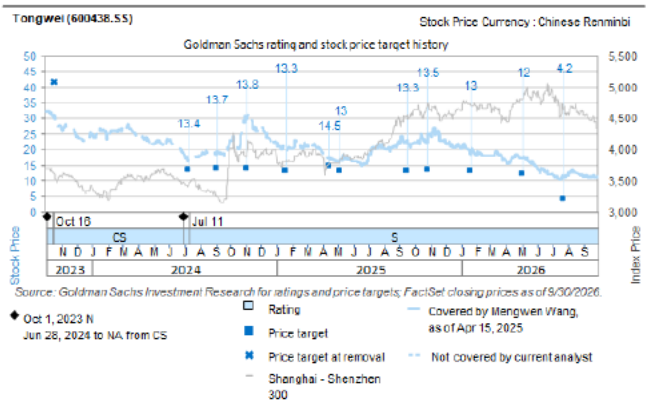
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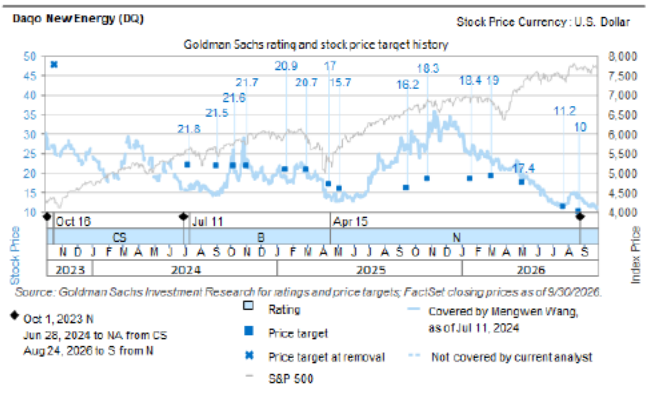
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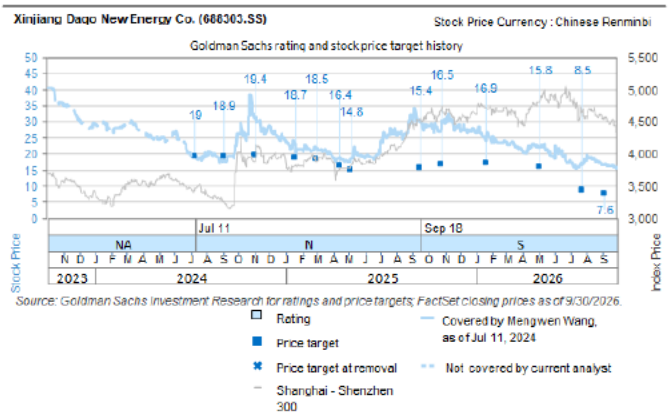
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Target price history table(s)

Daqo New Energy (DQ)

Date of report	Target price ($)	Closing price ($)
24-Aug-26	10.00	14.43
26-Jul-26	11.20	11.67
05-May-26	17.40	20.01
03-Mar-26	19.00	22.60
21-Jan-26	18.40	24.54
29-Oct-25	18.30	30.48
18-Sep-25	16.20	25.99
07-May-25	15.70	13.00
15-Apr-25	17.00	14.43
03-Mar-25	20.70	18.62
20-Jan-25	20.90	19.07
04-Nov-24	21.70	23.41
10-Oct-24	21.60	20.00
04-Sep-24	21.50	15.03
11-Jul-24	21.80	16.42

Tongwei (600438.SS)

Date of report	Target price (Rmb)	Closing price (Rmb)
26-Jul-26	4.20	11.14
05-May-26	12.00	17.37
21-Jan-26	13.00	18.49
29-Oct-25	13.50	24.87
18-Sep-25	13.30	22.10
07-May-25	13.00	16.70
15-Apr-25	14.50	17.25
20-Jan-25	13.30	21.17
04-Nov-24	13.80	30.40
04-Sep-24	13.70	19.20
11-Jul-24	13.40	17.25

Xinjiang Daqo New Energy Co. (688303.SS)

Date of report	Target price (Rmb)	Closing price (Rmb)
07-Sep-26	7.60	17.09
26-Jul-26	8.50	16.72
05-May-26	15.80	22.25
21-Jan-26	16.90	24.32

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Date of report	Target price (Rmb)	Closing price (Rmb)
29-Oct-25	16.50	30.45
18-Sep-25	15.40	29.63
07-May-25	14.80	18.58
15-Apr-25	16.40	18.65
03-Mar-25	18.50	21.85
20-Jan-25	18.70	22.27
04-Nov-24	19.40	30.85
04-Sep-24	18.90	18.00
11-Jul-24	19.00	19.34

Price targets shown in table(s) are unadjusted for corporate actions.

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